Quillmark Analytics Employee Handbook

Version 4.2, effective January 1, 2026. Owner: People Operations. Quillmark Analytics, Inc. is a fictional company.

1. Welcome to Quillmark

Quillmark Analytics, Inc. builds forecasting software for regional grocery chains and food distributors. The company was founded in 2017 in Portland, Oregon, by Dana Okafor and Luis Ferreira, and today employs about 340 people across offices in Portland, Austin and Toronto, plus a remote workforce in eleven US states and three Canadian provinces.

This handbook explains how we work, what you can expect from Quillmark, and what Quillmark expects from you. It applies to all full-time and part-time employees. Contractors are covered by their individual agreements. Where this handbook conflicts with a more specific, newer policy (for example, the Information Security Policy), the newer policy wins.

If you have questions about anything in this handbook, contact People Operations at people@quillmark.example or post in the #ask-people channel.

2. Working Hours and Location

2.1 Core hours

Quillmark operates on a flexible schedule. Every employee is expected to be available during core collaboration hours of **10:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. in their team's home time zone**, Monday through Friday. Outside core hours you may arrange your day as you see fit, provided you work your contracted hours (40 per week for full-time staff).

2.2 Hybrid and remote work

Employees assigned to an office are expected on site **two days per week**, chosen with their team. Tuesdays are "anchor days" when most teams meet in person. Fully remote employees must live in a state or province where Quillmark is registered as an employer; moving to a new state or province requires approval from People Operations at least 45 days in advance.

Remote employees receive a one-time home office stipend of **$750** in their first 60 days and an internet allowance of **$60 per month**, paid through payroll.

2.3 Working from abroad

You may work from outside your home country for up to **20 working days per calendar year**, with manager approval and a completed Travel Work Request (form PO-17) submitted at least two weeks before departure. Some countries are excluded for legal or security reasons; see the list on the intranet.

3. Time Off

3.1 Paid time off (PTO)

Full-time employees accrue paid time off according to length of service:

Years of service	PTO days per year	Accrual per pay period
Less than 2 years	18 days	0.69 days
2 to 5 years	22 days	0.85 days
More than 5 years	26 days	1.00 day

Part-time employees accrue PTO in proportion to their scheduled hours. You may carry over up to **5 unused PTO days** into the next calendar year; any balance above that is forfeited on January 1. Carried-over days must be used by March 31.

Requests for five or more consecutive days should be made at least four weeks in advance through the HR portal (Workday). Your manager should respond within three business days.

3.2 Company holidays

Quillmark observes ten paid holidays each year plus a company-wide "recharge week" between December 24 and January 1, when offices close. The holiday calendar for each country is published on the intranet each November.

3.3 Sick leave

Sick leave is separate from PTO. Employees receive **10 paid sick days per year**, which do not carry over. You do not need a doctor's note for absences of three days or fewer. For longer absences, People Operations may request documentation.

3.4 Parental leave

Employees who have been with Quillmark for at least six months are eligible for **16 weeks of fully paid parental leave** after the birth, adoption or foster placement of a child. Leave may be taken in up to two blocks within 12 months of the event. Where government parental benefits apply (for example in Canada), Quillmark tops up those benefits to 100% of base salary for the same 16 weeks.

3.5 Bereavement leave

Up to **5 paid days** for the death of an immediate family member, and up to 2 days for other relatives or close friends.

4. Pay, Expenses and Equipment

4.1 Pay schedule

Employees are paid semi-monthly, on the 15th and the last business day of each month. Salary reviews happen once a year in April, based on the performance cycle described in Section 6.

4.2 Business expenses

Quillmark reimburses reasonable expenses incurred for business purposes. Submit claims through Expensify within **30 days** of the expense, with an itemized receipt for any item over $25.

Expense type	Limit	Notes
Hotel	$250 per night	$325 in New York, San Francisco and Toronto
Meals while travelling	$75 per day	Alcohol is not reimbursable
Client entertainment	$120 per person	Requires director approval in advance
Airfare	Economy class	Premium economy allowed for flights over 6 hours
Mileage	IRS standard rate (US), CRA rate (Canada)	Log trips in Expensify
Learning and conferences	$2,000 per year	See Section 6.3

Expenses above these limits need written approval from your director before you spend the money. Claims submitted more than 90 days after the expense will not be reimbursed.

4.3 Company equipment

New employees receive a laptop (MacBook Pro or Lenovo ThinkPad, your choice), a monitor and a headset. Equipment remains Quillmark property and must be returned within 10 days of your last working day. Lost or stolen equipment must be reported to the IT Service Desk within 24 hours.

4.4 Passwords and account security

Choose a strong password of at least 10 characters for your Quillmark account and change it every **90 days**. Never share your password with anyone, including IT staff. Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is required for email and the VPN.

5. Conduct

5.1 Respect and inclusion

Quillmark does not tolerate harassment or discrimination of any kind. Concerns can be raised with your manager, with People Operations, or anonymously through the EthicsLine service at 1-800-555-0142 (available 24 hours a day).

5.2 Confidential information

Customer data, forecasts, source code and pricing are confidential. Do not share them outside the company without a signed non-disclosure agreement and approval from Legal. Customer data must never be copied to personal devices or personal cloud storage.

5.3 Use of AI tools

Employees may use company-approved AI assistants for drafting, coding and analysis. Do not paste customer data, credentials or unreleased financial results into any AI tool that is not on the approved list maintained by the Security team.

5.4 Gifts

You may accept gifts from customers or vendors worth up to **$100** per year per company. Gifts worth more must be declined or reported to Legal.

6. Performance and Growth

6.1 Performance cycle

Quillmark runs one formal performance review per year, completed in March, plus a lighter mid-year check-in in September. Ratings use a four-point scale: Exceeds, Strong, Developing and Below Expectations.

6.2 Promotions

Promotions are decided twice a year, in April and October, by a calibration committee in each department.

6.3 Learning budget

Each employee has a learning budget of **$2,000 per calendar year** for courses, books, certifications and conferences. Unused budget does not roll over.

7. Leaving Quillmark

Please give at least **two weeks' notice** of resignation (four weeks for managers). Accrued, unused PTO is paid out in your final paycheck where required by local law. Your accounts are disabled at 5:00 p.m. local time on your last day.